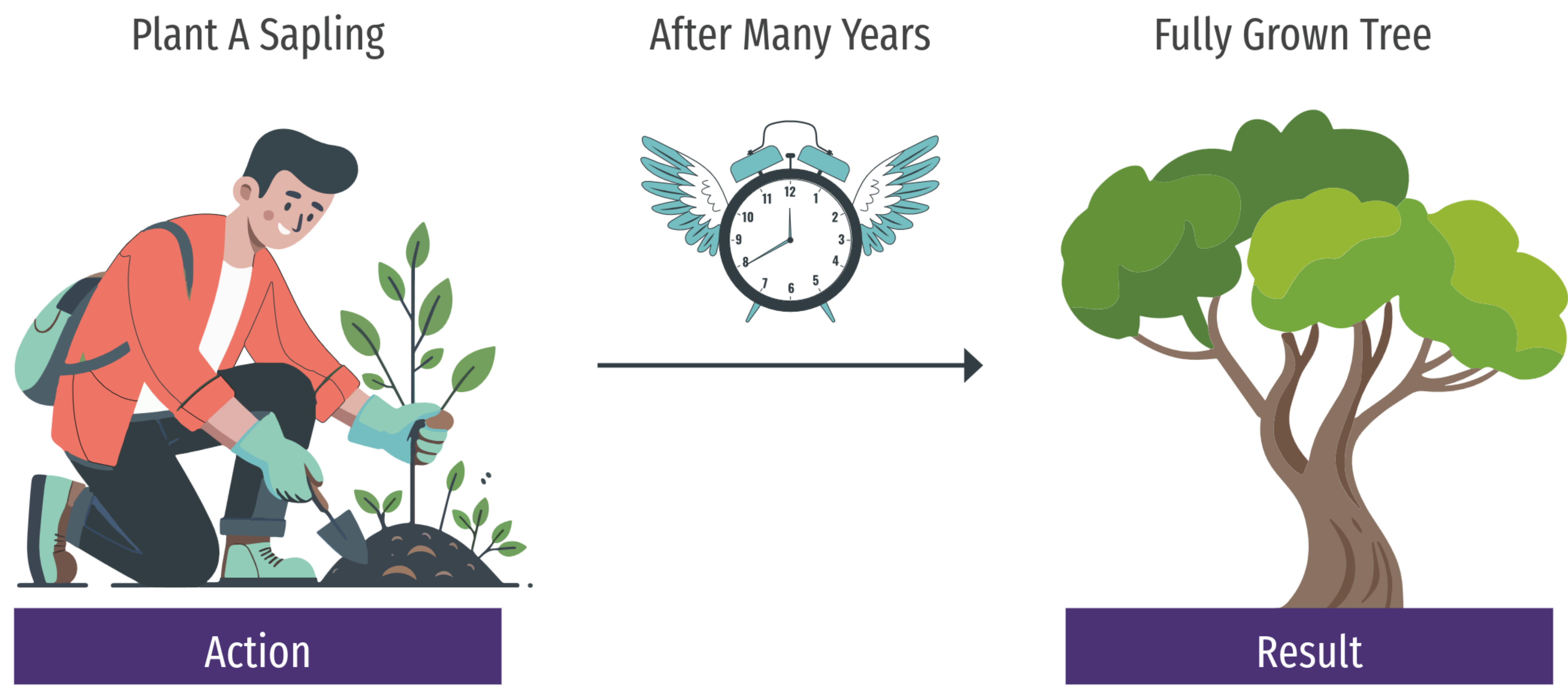
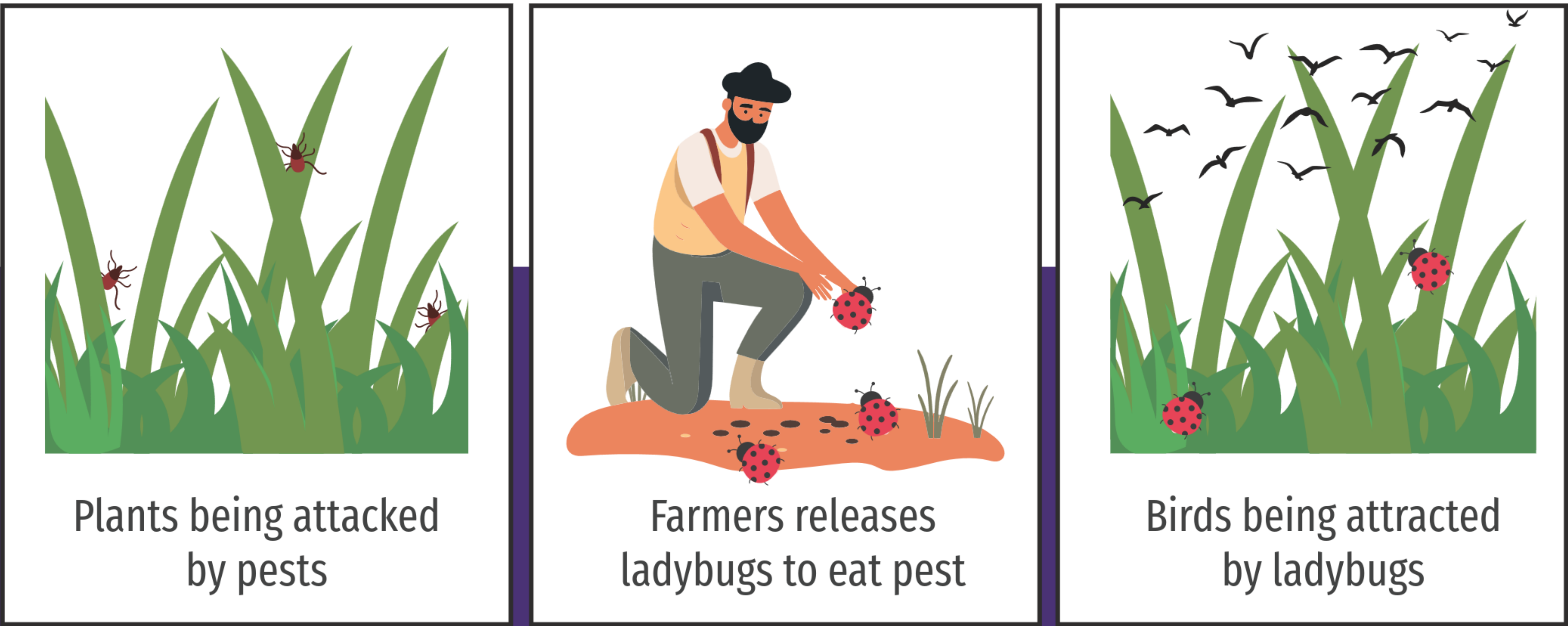


Recognising System Dynamics

When you plant trees, they don't grow instantly; it takes time for them to grow and flourish. This is like a delay in a system; there is a gap between when you do something and when you see the results. At first, the plants grow faster, but if you overwater them, they may drown. This demonstrates a non-linear relationship.



Systems thinking helps us understand these dynamic aspects of systems: delays, nonlinear relationships, and emergent behaviours. By recognising them, decision-makers can better anticipate how changes in one part of the system will affect the system as a whole, leading to more informed and effective decision-making. Imagine introducing ladybirds to eat the pests in your garden.



Suddenly, you notice more birds visiting because they're attracted to the ladybugs. This unexpected outcome is an emergent behaviour.